

GEOGRAPHY

PHYSICAL GEOGRAPHY



CLIMATOLOGY

MODULE – 36

WORLD CLIMATIC TYPES
THE MEDITERRANEAN CLIMATE
(PART- 2)

4

MEDITERRANEAN CLIMATE

NATURAL VEGETATION

Various types of vegetation are found in the Mediterranean regions.

TYPE- 1

MEDITERRANEAN EVERGREEN FORESTS



- 1 These are open woodlands with evergreen oaks, of which the cork oaks of Spain and Portugal are the best known.
- 2 They are found only in the climatically most favoured regions with a rainfall of well over 25 inches.

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MEDITERRANEAN CLIMATE

NATURAL VEGETATION

TYPE- 1

MEDITERRANEAN EVERGREEN FORESTS



Karri trees of Australia

- 3 The trees are normally low, even stunted, with massive trunks, deeply fissured barks, small leathery leaves and a wide-spreading root system in search of water.
- 4 The cork oaks are specially valued for their thick barks, used for making wine-bottle corks and for export around the world.
- 5 In Australia, the eucalyptus forests replace the evergreen oak. The jarrah and karri trees are commercially the most important. The giant sequoia or redwood is typical of the Californian trees.

KARRI TREES OF AUSTRALIA



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MEDITERRANEAN CLIMATE

NATURAL VEGETATION

TYPE- 2

EVERGREEN CONIFEROUS TREES



Cypresses

- 1 These include the various kinds of pines, firs, cedars and cypresses which have evergreen, needle-shaped leaves and tall straight trunks.
- 2 They appear more on the cooler highlands and where droughts are less severe. Deforestation has reduced their numbers considerably.

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MEDITERRANEAN CLIMATE

NATURAL VEGETATION

TYPE- 3

MEDITERRANEAN BUSHES AND SHRUBS

- 1 This is perhaps the most predominant type of Mediterranean vegetation. Summers are so dry and hot that in places forests give place to short, evergreen shrubs and bushes.



- 2 The low bushes grow in scattered clumps and are often thorny.
- 3 The more common species are laurel, myrtle, lavender, arbutus, and rosemary, of which a number are strongly scented or perfumed.
- 4 In many areas, due to man's interference in forest depletion or to overgrazing, the original woodlands degenerate into a scrub vegetation with scattered, stunted trees and tall bushes.

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MEDITERRANEAN CLIMATE

NATURAL VEGETATION

TYPE- 4

GRASS

- 1 Conditions in the Mediterranean do not suit grass, because most of the rain comes in the cool season when growth is slow.



- 2 Slow-growing vegetation, which cannot replenish its foliage readily, and which is without deep-penetrating roots, is least suited here.
- 3 Even if grasses do survive, they are so wiry and bunchy that they are not suitable for animal farming. Cattle rearing is thus unimportant in the Mediterranean.
- 4 Animal fats are not important here and the chief cooking oil is obtained from olives. Dairy products are net import items.

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MEDITERRANEAN CLIMATE

ECONOMIC DEVELOPMENT OF THE MEDITERRANEAN REGIONS

- 1 Despite the semi-arid conditions that cover many parts of the Mediterranean lands, the climate as a whole is favorable.



- 2 Its warm, bright summers and cool, moist winters enable a wide range of crops to be cultivated.
- 3 One must not forget that the Mediterranean shore-lands were once the cradle of world civilization.
- 4 Nowadays the area is important for fruit cultivation, cereal growing, wine-making and agricultural industries, as well as engineering and mining. We shall deal with some of them in greater detail below.

4

MEDITERRANEAN CLIMATE

ECONOMIC DEVELOPMENT OF THE
MEDITERRANEAN REGIONS

Various types of economic activities found in the Mediterranean regions.

TYPE- 1

ORCHARD FARMING



1 The Mediterranean lands are also known as the world's orchard lands. A wide range of citrus fruits such as oranges, lemons, limes, citrons and grapefruit are grown.

2 The fruit trees have long roots to draw water from considerable depths during the long summer drought.

3 In exceptionally dry areas, irrigation helps to relieve the lack of moisture.

4

MEDITERRANEAN CLIMATE**ECONOMIC DEVELOPMENT OF THE
MEDITERRANEAN REGIONS****TYPE- 1****ORCHARD FARMING**

- 4** In the Great Valley of California, the Vale of Chile, the Negev Desert of Israel and the northern shores of Mediterranean Europe, an elaborate system of irrigation canals enables both fruits and cereals to be successfully raised.



Negev Desert of Israel



Great Valley of California

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MEDITERRANEAN CLIMATE

ECONOMIC DEVELOPMENT OF THE MEDITERRANEAN REGIONS

TYPE- 1

ORCHARD FARMING



Sunkist oranges from California

- 5 The thick, leathery skin of the citrus fruits prevents excessive transpiration and the long, sunny summer enables the fruits to be ripened and harvested.
- 6 The various Mediterranean oranges are so distinctive in their shape, size, taste and quality that they are called by different names in their area of production.
- 7 Of the Mediterranean oranges, perhaps, the best known are the Sunkist oranges from California, exported for table consumption and for making orange squash.

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MEDITERRANEAN CLIMATE

ECONOMIC DEVELOPMENT OF THE
MEDITERRANEAN REGIONS

TYPE- 1

ORCHARD FARMING

**Mandarin oranges**

8

In the temperate monsoon lands of the China and Japan, which were, in fact, the native home of the orange, commercial cultivation of the fruit is less significant, and only in recent years has there been any serious effort made to popularize their export as “mandarin oranges”.

9

The Mediterranean lands account for 70 percent of the world's exports of citrus fruits.

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MEDITERRANEAN CLIMATE

ECONOMIC DEVELOPMENT OF THE
MEDITERRANEAN REGIONS

TYPE- 1

ORCHARD FARMING



Olives

10 The olive tree is probably the most typical of all Mediterranean cultivated vegetation. It is so hardy and long rooted that it can survive even on very poor limestone soils with less than 10 inches, of annual rainfall.

11 Like, our coconut palm, the olive tree is very “versatile” and has many uses.

12 The olive can be eaten fresh or pickled with spices. The fleshy part can be crushed and olive oil is extracted, a valuable source of cooking oil in a region deficient in animal fat.

ECONOMIC DEVELOPMENT OF THE
MEDITERRANEAN REGIONS

TYPE- 1

ORCHARD FARMING

- 13** Besides olives, many nut trees like chestnuts, walnuts, hazelnuts and almonds are grown and the nuts picked as fruits or for the peaches, apricots, pears, plums, cherries, and figs.



Chestnut



Walnut



Hazelnut

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MEDITERRANEAN CLIMATE

ECONOMIC DEVELOPMENT OF THE
MEDITERRANEAN REGIONS

TYPE- 2

CROP CULTIVATION



- 1 Besides orchard fruits, the Mediterranean climate also supports many field crops.
- 2 Cereals are by far the most important. Wheat is the leading food crop, Though conditions for extensive wheat cultivation are not as ideal as those of the cool temperature regions, the Mediterranean farmers have utilized the seasonal climatic rhythm to their best advantage.
- 3 The wheat grown is mainly hard, winter wheat. It is suitable for both bread-making and other food-products such as macaroni, spaghetti and vermicelli.

4

MEDITERRANEAN CLIMATE

ECONOMIC DEVELOPMENT OF THE
MEDITERRANEAN REGIONS

TYPE- 2

CROP CULTIVATION

- 4 Summer crops are raised only where irrigation is possible. The water comes mainly from the melting snow that feeds the many rivers whose sources are in the highlands.



Rice cultivation in Po valley

- 5 Lowlands are intensively cultivated and the hill slopes are terraced.
- 6 In a few localities, eg. the Ebro basin in Spain, the Po Valley in Italy and in California, rice has been successfully cultivated and their yields are some of the highest in the world.
- 7 In the more fertile plains, vegetables, especially beans and flowers are grown for the local market. A Little cotton and tobacco are also grown.

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MEDITERRANEAN CLIMATE

ECONOMIC DEVELOPMENT OF THE MEDITERRANEAN REGIONS

TYPE- 3

WINE PRODUCTION

- 1** Wine production is another specialty of the Mediterranean counties.



- 2** Some 85 per cent of grapes produced, go into wine. The long, sunny summer allows the grapes to ripen and then they are hand-picked.

- 3** Viticulture is by tradition a Mediterranean occupation and the regions bordering the Mediterranean Sea account for three-quarters of the world's production of wine.

- 4** In Spain, Portugal, France, and Italy, wine is the national drink.

4

MEDITERRANEAN CLIMATE

ECONOMIC DEVELOPMENT OF THE
MEDITERRANEAN REGIONS

TYPE- 3

WINE PRODUCTION



4 Although, grapes may be grown in many parts of the temperate lands, commercial viticulture is almost entirely confined to the Mediterranean regions.

5 The quality of the fermented grape juice is decided by a number of factors including the types of vines grown, the quality of the soil, the climate of the region, the method and extent of fermentation.

6 The fragrance, taste and quality of the final product is so varied that the price range is tremendous.

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MEDITERRANEAN CLIMATE

ECONOMIC DEVELOPMENT OF THE
MEDITERRANEAN REGIONS

TYPE- 3

WINE PRODUCTION



7

In France, the greatest wine regions are located further north, e.g. Champagne in the Paris basin, Bordeaux in the Garonne basin, Burgundy in the Rhone-Saone Valley.

8

Most of the inferior grapes are preserved as dried grapes and exported. They are known by several names e.g. currants from the Levantine grapes, raisins from California and Sultanas from Asia Minor.

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